Validating Expected Parrot: Lasagna Coke

We rebuilt the public study locally, then isolated persona and elicitation effects with Qwen.

validate-expected-parrot
Private reproducible baseline

12 PERSONAS	3 SEGMENTS	7 QUESTIONS	84 EP MODEL CALLS

How the personas differed

baseline vs. Expected Parrot

DIMENSION	OUR BASELINE	EP PERSONAS
Profile	Short attitude-based descriptions	Named, age-specific biographies with jobs and lifestyles
Adventurous	General novelty seeking	Chef • creator • trend follower • collector
Mainstream	General preference for familiar soda	Habit • classic taste • bounded novelty • brand loyalty
Health-conscious	General concern about sugar and processing	Labels • macros • food science • parental responsibility
Behavioral effect	More moderate, averaged responses	Stronger identity cues and clearer reasons to polarize

Overall appeal

segment mean, 1–5

CONDITION	ADVENTUROUS	MAINSTREAM	HEALTH-CONSCIOUS	RANGE
Our original baseline	4.25	2.50	2.00	**2.25**
Our run + EP personas	4.00	1.75	1.75	**2.25**
Expected Parrot	**4.75**	**1.00**	**1.00**	**3.75**

Purchase intent

segment mean, 1–5

CONDITION	ADVENTUROUS	MAINSTREAM	HEALTH-CONSCIOUS	RANGE
Our original baseline	3.25	2.00	1.75	**1.50**
Our run + EP personas	4.00	1.25	1.00	**3.00**
Expected Parrot	**4.50**	**3.00**	**1.50**	**3.00**

Overall means

EP-like separate calls

MEASURE	OUR QWEN	EP
Appeal	2.25	2.25
Clarity	3.83	3.83
Uniqueness	3.08	3.00
Purchase intent	3.17	3.00

Same average ≠ same mechanism

EP's rich personas reproduced the **purchase-intent spread**. But subgroup errors canceled: Qwen was less enthusiastic among adventurous consumers and more willing among mainstream consumers.

Key result: Persona design explains much of the polarization; model + image + elicitation still matter.

Synthetic hypotheses—not population estimates.